



Around the World in Umpteen Proverbs

IHS-Global Lit

It is with words as with sunbeams,



The more they are condensed, the deeper they burn.

- Robert Southey

Proverbs

Folk wisdom passed down within a society that gives us a window into its lifestyle, values, history, and culture; more simply, their just a way of expressing a well-known truth based on common sense or experience.





How They're Used

Advising, warning,

criticizing, encouraging,

informing, and expressing

feelings

Why They Last

Stylistically set apart from regular speech, they're often metaphorical or symbolic in nature; but more than that, they're timeless, which is to say they're equally applicable to all peoples independent of the era of their birth, including you.





Splitting Semantic Hairs

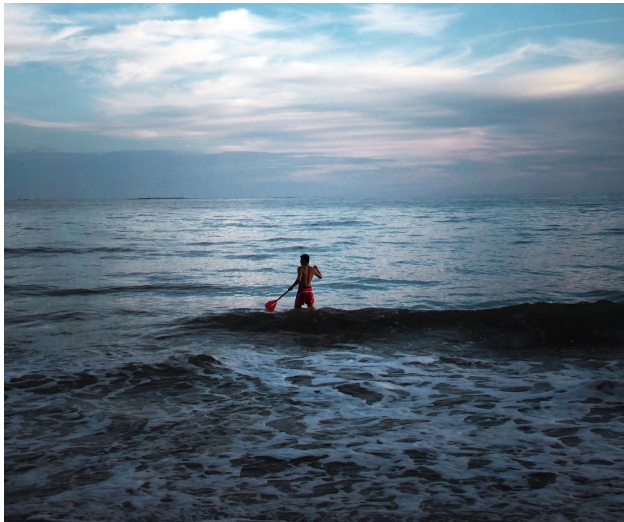
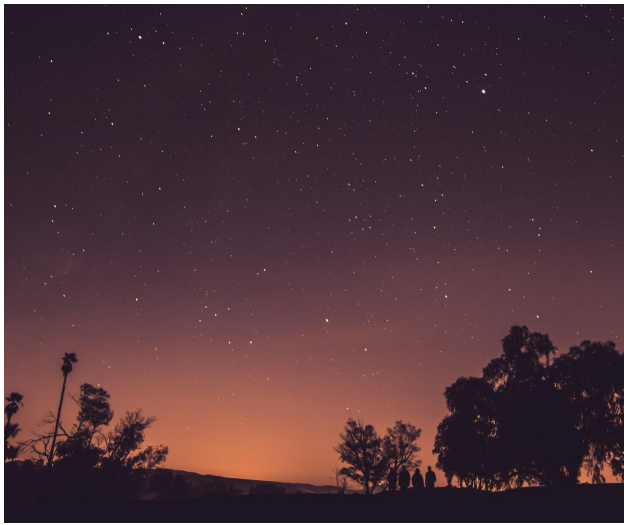
Idioms - colloquial expressions that gains traction in a culture, not necessarily advisory

“It’s raining cats and dogs”

Aphorisms - literal in nature, requires no interpretation “easy come, easy go”

Proverbs - metaphorical in nature, often requiring a deeper interpretation

Proverbs From Around The World



Where's that from?



I show the proverb, you guess the country



China

It is better to light a candle
Than to curse the darkness

France

In love, there is always one
who kisses, and one who
offers the cheek





Congo

No man can paddle

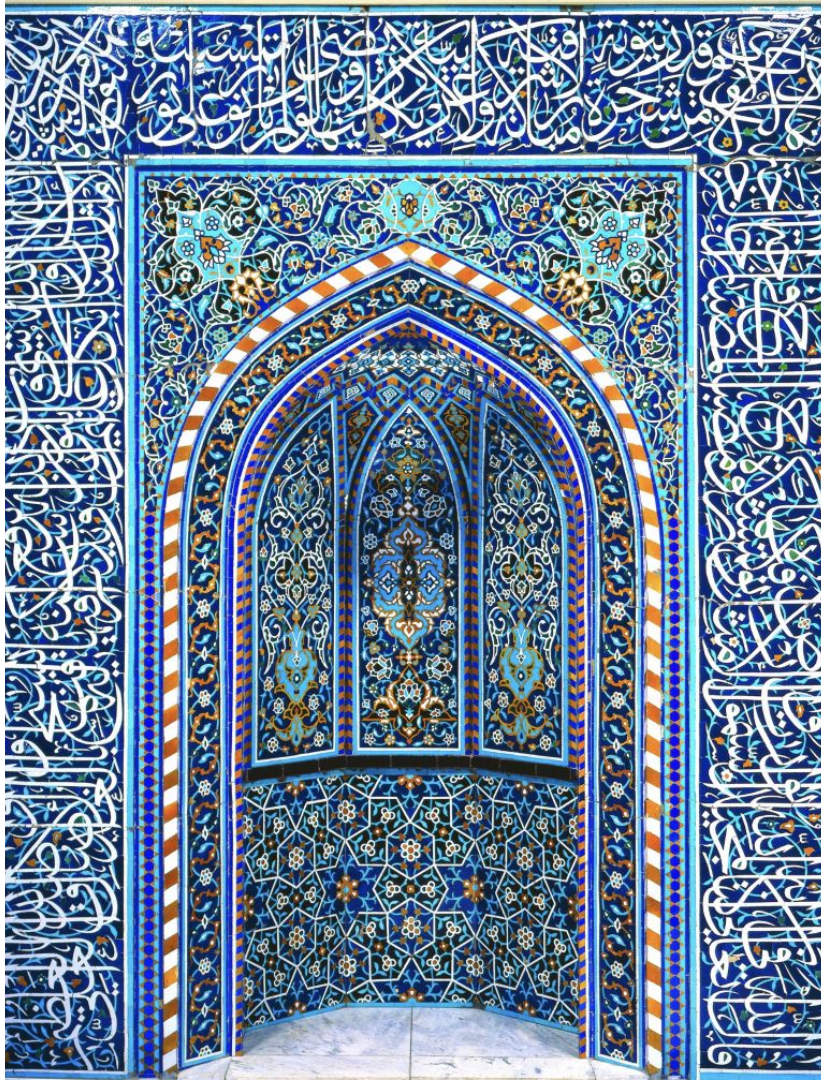
two canoes at once

—

Slovenia

Speak the truth, but
leave immediately
afterward





India

To the world wisdom
is folly; to the wise
the world is foolish



Mexico

As you see yourself, I once
saw myself. As you see me
now, so too will you be
seen.

Japan

A joke is a hole through
which truth whistles

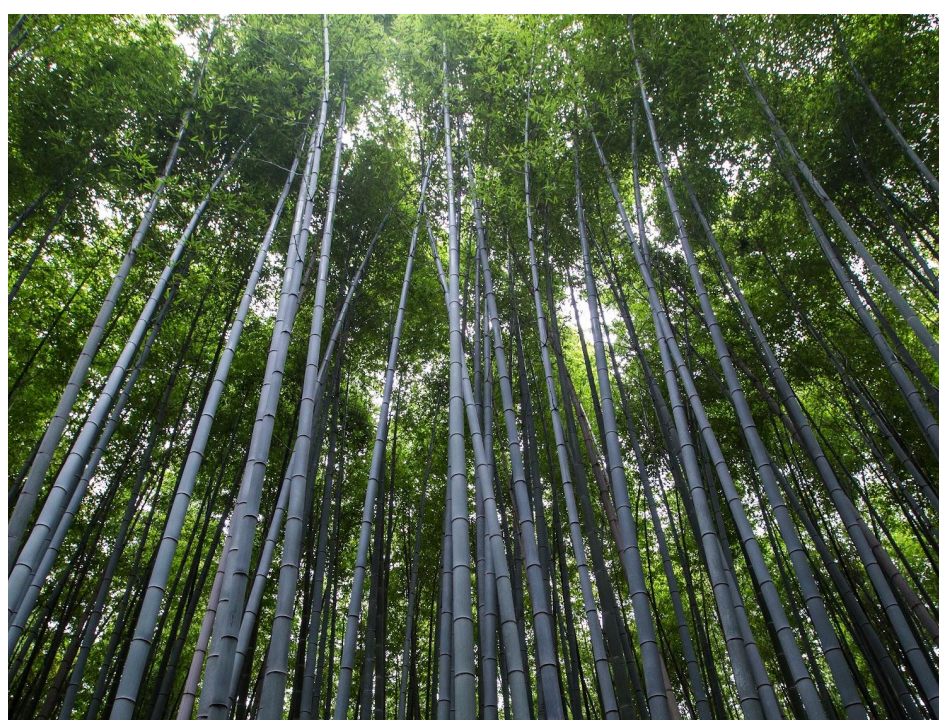
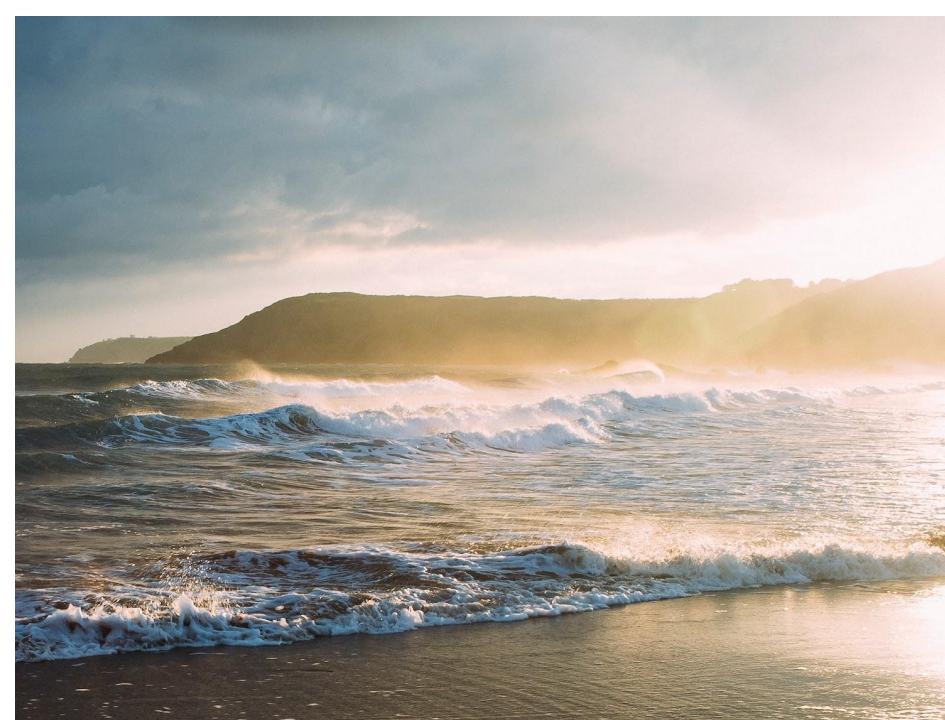




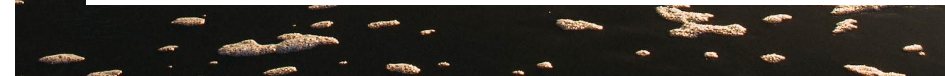
So What's Next?

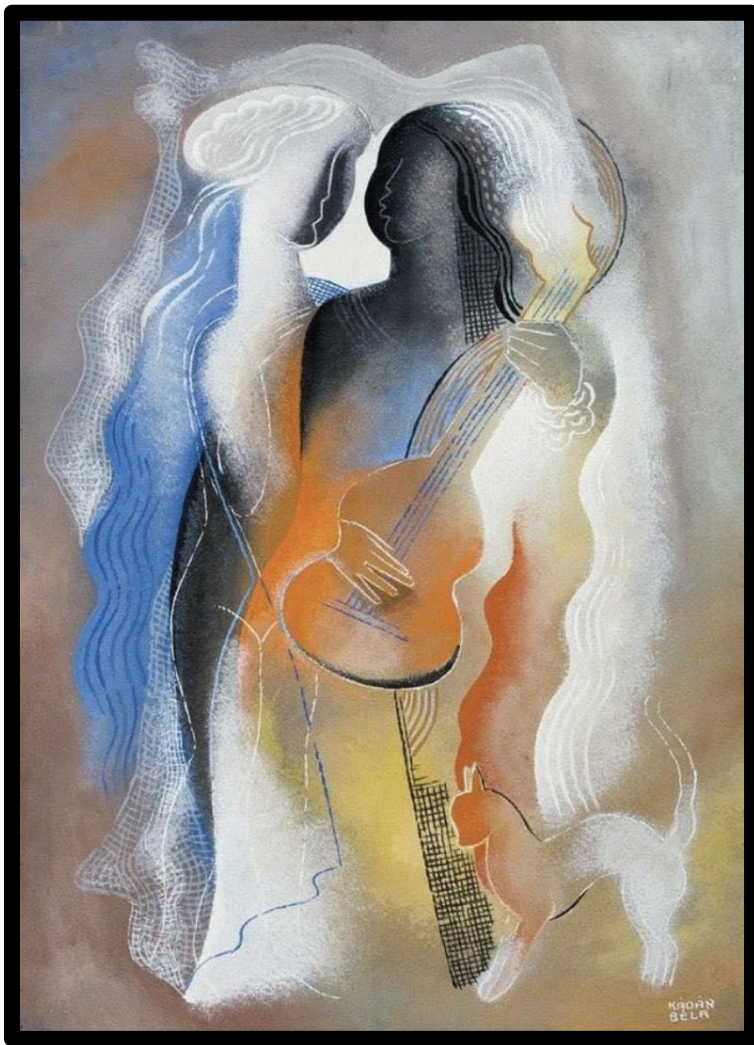


The Microlab



Here's how it works





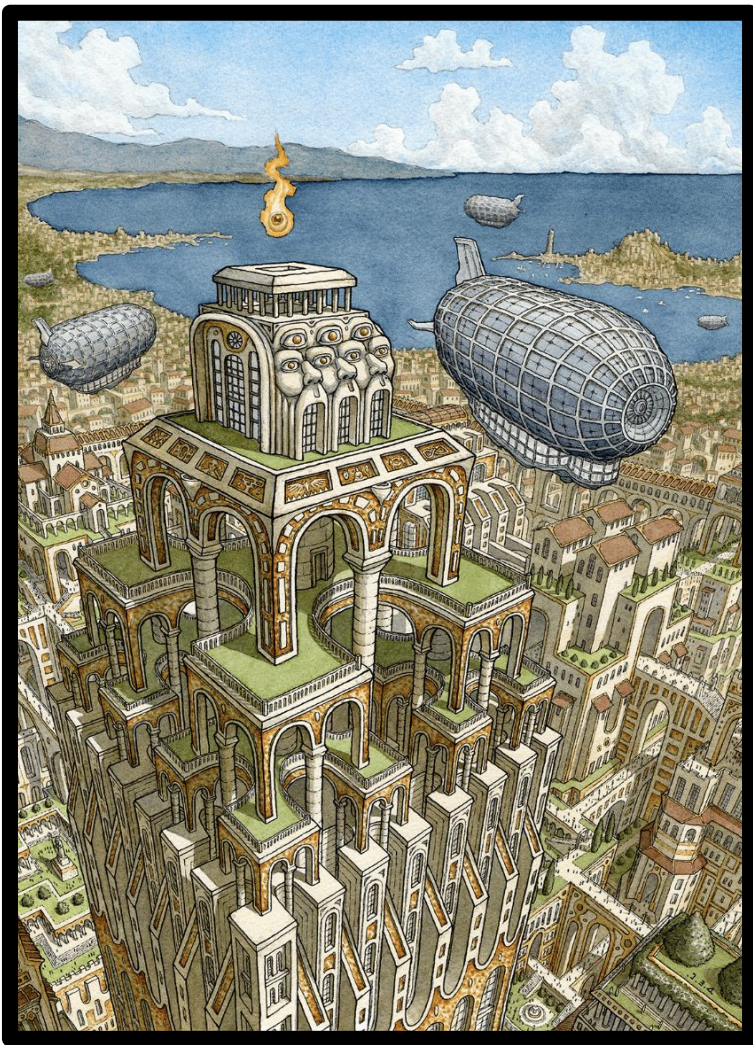
Step 1

Pick three principles from
columns in step 1 (or come
up with your own)

Step 2

Select 3 proverbs that say something about those principles.





Step 3

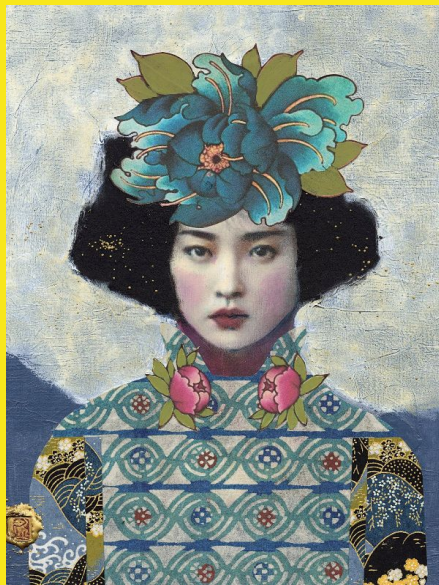
Provide an
interpretation in
your own words

Step 4

Merge into
groups of four,
delegate roles



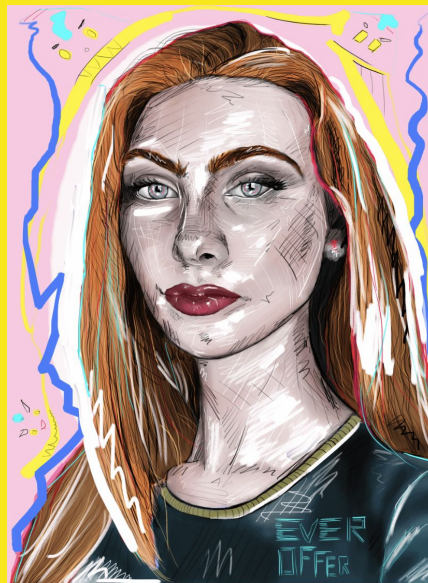
Scribe



Moderator



Presenter



Timekeeper





Step 5

Share your

favorite proverb

with the group

Present

Presenters, prepare
your group's top
choice to present to
the class.





Present

Proverb
Principle
Interpretation
Significance

Discuss

Take a minute to reflect
with your group on
their findings.



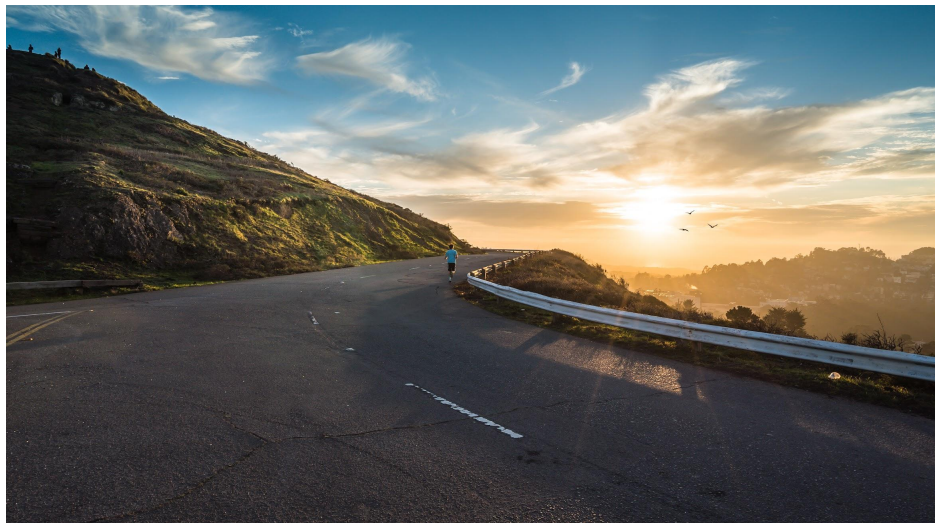
Final Thoughts

- Best used when well-timed and apt to a topic in conversation.
- Overused, they have the effect of falling stale on the ear (and inciting a few eye rolls)



If you want to go
fast, go alone. If
you want to go far,
go together.

African Proverb



GOOD JOB

